

Fundamentals of Communication

Origin & Scope of Communication

The word communication is derived from the Latin word "communicare" which means to "share". It is not certain when human beings first began to communicate. Words written on papyrus leaves have been in existence for thousands of years. Since, communication is an integral part of our daily and professional lives, it's important for us to know what communication is.

Definition

Communication is the exchange of information, ideas and knowledge between sender and receiver through an accepted code of symbols.

Features (Elements) of Communication

Sender: The sender is the person who conceives an idea and wants to share it.

Idea: It is the information that the sender sends.

Message Encoding: When the sender converts the idea into the message form (words, images), it is called encoding.

Medium: The form that the message takes, is known as medium. The media transmitting messages can be oral, written, visual and various electronic forms.

Channel: It is the system used to deliver the message. The channel can be; face-to-face conversation, internet, person.

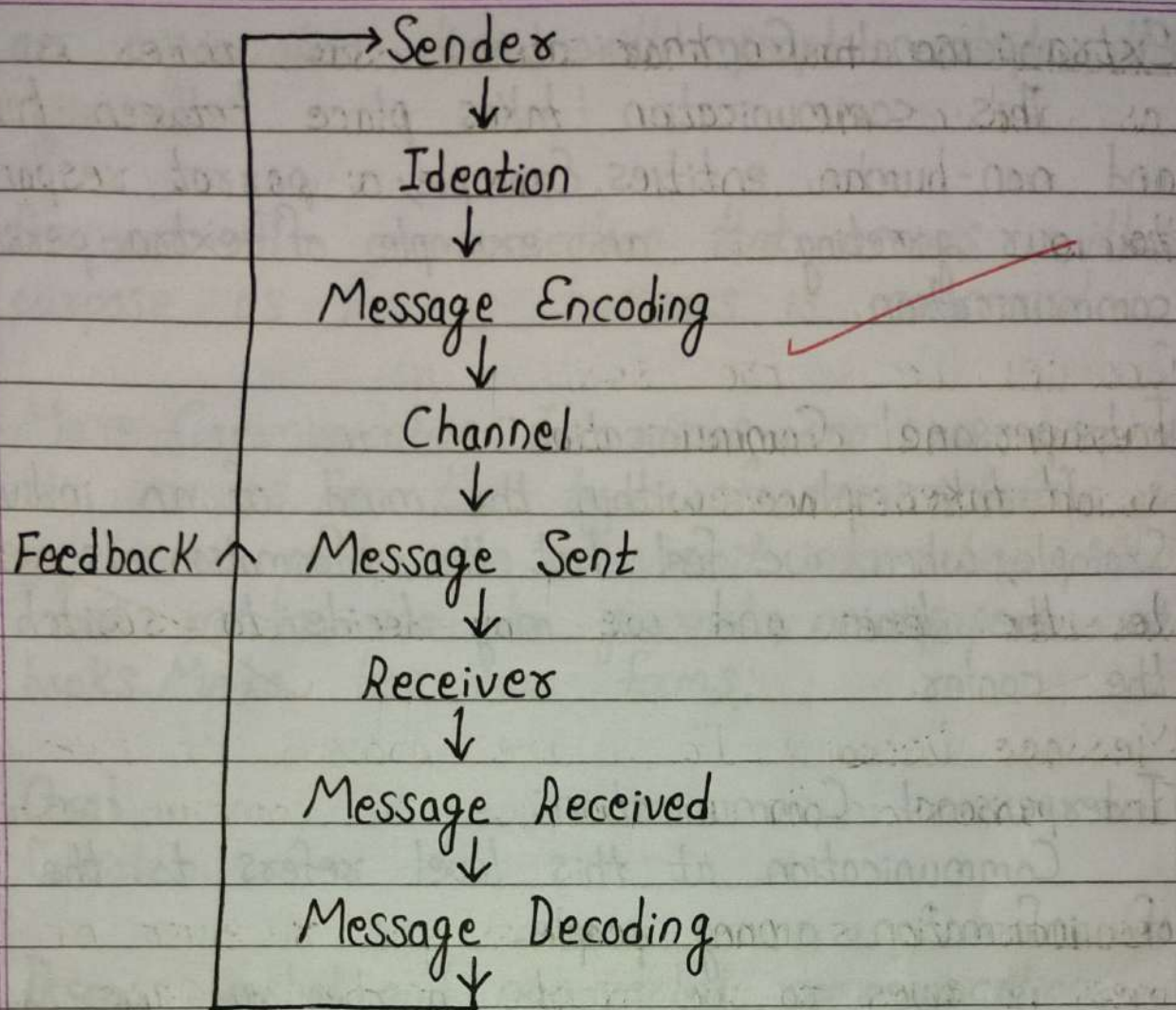
Receiver: Receiver is the intended audience.

Message Decoding: It is the process of interpreting and understanding a message in communication.

Feedback: It is the response the receiver of the message gives to the sender of the message. It helps the sender understand that his message is understood and received as intended.

Process of Communication

The sender has an idea. He encodes it (the idea/message) and sends it through a channel. The receiver receives the message and decodes it. If the message received is the same as the message sent there will be feedback. If not so, it means there is breakdown of communication. This breakdown of communication may be because of 'noise'.



Q) Humans communication takes place at various levels. Discuss.

⇒ Communication is a universal and multidimensional activity. Human communication takes place at various levels. Various levels are:

- Extra-personal
- Intrapersonal
- Interpersonal
- Organizational
- Mass

1. Extra-personal Communication:

This communication takes place between human and non-human entities. Example; a parrot responding to our greeting is an example of extra-personal communication.

2. Intrapersonal Communication:

It takes place within the mind of an individual. Example; when we feel hot the information is sent to the brain and we may decide to switch on the cooler.

3. Interpersonal Communication:

Communication at this level refers to the sharing of information among people.

- (i) Participants are in close physical proximity to each other.
- (ii) Many sensory channels are involved.
- (iii) Feedback is immediate.
- (iv) The role of sender and receiver keeps alternating.

4. Organizational Communication:

It is extremely important for the sustenance of any organization. It can be of three types;

- (i) Internal-operational: This communication occurs in conducting work within an organization.
- (ii) External-operational: This is related to communication that

an organization does with people outside the organization.

(iii) Personal: All communication that occurs without purpose as far as business is concerned.

5. Mass Communication: It means communication with the masses. For this type of communication, we require a media to transmit information. Media or mass media can be journals, newspapers and books. Media has two forms;

- (i) Oral
- (ii) Written.

Q) Discuss verbal and non-verbal communication.

⇒ Verbal and non-verbal communication both are fundamental ways of communication among human individuals.

1. Verbal Communication:

It uses spoken (Oral Communication) or written words (written communication) to convey information, ideas and emotions.

(i) Oral Communication: In the professional world this communication takes place through speaking. It requires proper knowledge of the subject, logical ordering of words, right pronunciation and articulation.

Fluency, confidence, proper pitch and volume are the other essentials.

Different forms of formal oral communication are:

- Face-to-face conversations
- Telephone conversations
- Group discussions
- Workshops
- Seminars
- Presentations
- Speeches
- Meetings

(ii) Written Communication: This type of communication uses the written word. It depends on appropriate words, syntax, grammar and vocabulary.

In the professional world, written forms of communication are:

- Job application letters
- Resumes
- Curriculum Vitae
- Notices
- Circulars
- Bulletins
- Brochures
- E-Mails
- Reports & Proposals

- Emails
- Formal letters.

2. Non-Verbal communication:

This communication takes place without the use of word or spoken language. It is extremely important because people see us before they hear us. In general communication, words are only 7% effective. This communication can repeat, compliment, regulate or contradict verbal communication. It can also have a great impact on social interactions.

Non-verbal communication can involve a variety of visual and vocal cues. It includes the following:

- (1) Kinetics: The word Kinetics has come from the root word 'kinesis' which means movement. Kinesics is the name given to the study of the body's physical movements. Body languages includes the following aspects of our appearance:
 - (i) Personal Appearance: People see us before they hear us. One's appearance can put the person into good or hostile attitude. Personal appearance includes clothes, hair, jewellery, cosmetics and so on.
 - (ii) Eye Contact: The study of eye behaviour is called oulesics. "Eyes are the windows to our souls." Eye-contact signals many things such as interest, affection, hostility or attraction. A famous

psychologist Paul Ekman says that our eyes are tell-tale signs.

Example; The smile is real when the eyes create 'crow's feet' at the outer corner, otherwise it may be fake.

(iii) Posture: Posture refers ^{to} the way we hold ourselves when we stand, sit or walk. ~~Different~~ types of postures are:

Slumped Posture - shows low spirits.

Erect Posture - shows high spirits, energy & confidence.

Lean Forward - shows that the person is open, honest & interested.

Lean Backward - defensive or disinterested.

Cross Arms - defensive

Uncrossed Arms - willingness to listen.

(iv) Gesture: It is the movement made by hands, arms, shoulders, head, etc. In the formal setting the following gestures should be avoided:

- Shuffling of legs
- Playing with a ring
- Twisting a chain
- Cracking knuckles
- Scratching head, biting nails
- Tapping feet
- Crossing arms or legs
- Clearing throat too often

(2) Haptics: It is the science and technology of using a person's sense of touch to transmit and understand information. How one person touches another communicates a great deal of information.

People have different areas of personal intimacy. A warm, loving touch can lead to positive outcomes while a violent touch can ultimately lead to a negative outcome. Striking, pushing, pulling and kicking are the forms of touch in the context of physical abuse.

(3) Chronemics: It is the study of how human beings communicate through their use of time. The most important thing at a work place is the management of time. When we are late for an appointment, people react negatively. If we arrive early, we are considered either over-eager or aggressive.

Examples; Long speeches are boring. Soon the listeners lose interest.

Very short speeches show lack of preparation and confidence.

(4) Proxemics: It means the space language. Space dimension or distance between us and other people tells us about our relation with others and the nature of our communication with them.

Edward T. Hall give four types of space language

Intimate Personal Social Public

Intimate Space Language - physical contact to 18 inches.

Personal Space Language - 18 inches to 4 feet.

Social Space Language - 4 to 12 feet.

Public Space Language - 12 feet to the range of hearing or seeing.

- (5) Visual Aids: Non-verbal communication can also include images, such as those in television, films, photographs and on the internet.
- (6) Artifacts: In communication, artifacts are objects that express human thought and can be used to convey meaning in social interactions. Clothing, body piercings, car model its colour and interior decoration.
- Examples; A police officer wears a specific uniform and a doctor wears a white coat. At a mere glance, these outfits tell others what that person does.
- (7) Paralinguistics: It is the communication effect of the following:

- (i) Quality of Voice: Abraham Lincoln and Winston Churchill worked on the quality of their voice to become excellent speakers.
- (ii) Volume: Volume is the loudness or softness of voice. Too high volume may sound boorish or sensitive. Too low volume conveys lack of confidence.
- (iii) Pace/Rate: Pace is the number of words spoken per minute. The normal rate is from 120 to 150 words per minute.
- (iv) Pitch: Pitch refers to the number of vibrations per second of our voice. A well-balanced pitch results in a clear and effective tone. High pitch shows excitement, joy and anger. Low pitch shows shock, guilt, sadness and dullness.
- (v) Pause: A pause is a short silence flanked by words.
- (vi) Articulation: It is the ability to speak distinctly and produce the sounds in a crisp and lucid manner. Example;
Right Articulation - I do not know.
Wrong Articulation - I dunno.
- (vii) Pronunciation: Good pronunciation requires us to speak our sounds in a way that is generally accepted.

The best way is to follow British Received Pronunciation.

(viii) Voice Modulation: Voice modulation pertains to the way we regulate, vary or adjust the tone, pitch and volume of the sound. We should pay attention to the word stress and sentence stress which play an important role in voice modulation.

Q.5) Distinguish between General and Technical communication.

⇒ Technical communication is the process of communicating a specific message to a specific audience with a specific purpose.

Forms of Technical Communication

Oral Forms

- 1- Telephonic conversations
- 2- Face to face conversations
- 3- Meetings
- 4- Seminars
- 5- Conferences
- 6- Instructions
- 7- Group Discussions
- 8- Presentations
- 9- Interviews

Written Forms

- 1- Reports
- 2- Proposals
- 3- E-mail
- 4- Brochures
- 5- Notices
- 6- Circulars
- 7- Business Letters
- 8- Research Papers
- 9- Resume

Technical Writing: According to Pauley and Riordan, "Technical writing is the practical writing that people do as a part of their jobs."

General Writing: This type of writing covers general topics that readers find interesting.

Difference between ~~Technical~~ Technical and General Writing:

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. Examples of technical writing are; reports, proposals, e-mail, brochures. | 1. Examples of general writing are; novels, plays, stories, poems, etc. |
| 2. Messages are specific. | 2. Messages are not specific. |
| 3. Messages are for a specific audience. | 3. Messages are not always for a specific audience. |
| 4. Messages have a specific purpose. The purpose may be; To inform, persuade or to instruct. | 4. The purpose may be mere delight. |
| 5. Formal style and approach. | 5. Informal style and approach. |
| 6. There is a set pattern of communication. | 6. There is no set pattern of communication. |
| 7. The approach is objective. | 7. The approach may be subjective. |

8. It involves jargons frequently.

8. It does not involve jargon.

9. Important features are; Accuracy, Brevity and Clarity.

9. It may be lengthy, inaccurate and ambiguous.

10. Arrangement of ideas follow a logical order.

10. Arrangement of ideas does not always follow a rational order.

Q.6) What are the 7Cs of communication? Discuss.

⇒ Clear and effective communication is a vital skill in life and at work. While there are lots of different communication tools and techniques that help us to improve, the 7Cs offer an easy way to ensure that our communication is always effective. The 7Cs of effective communication are:

1. Clarity:

Make sure that it's easy for your reader to understand your meaning. People shouldn't have to read between the lines and make assumptions on their own to understand what you're trying to say.

2. Conciseness:

"Brevity is the soul of wit" has been rightly said by Shakespeare. Your audience doesn't want to read six sentences when you could communicate your message in three.

3. Concreteness:

When your message is concrete, your audience has a clear picture of what you're telling them. There are details (but not too many!) and vivid facts and there's laser-like focus. Your message is solid.

4. Correctness:

When your communication is correct, your audience will be able to understand it. Both the details and the language used for communication should be correct.

5. Coherence:

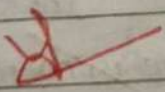
When your communication is coherent, it's logical. All points are connected and relevant to the main topic, and the tone and flow of the text is consistent.

6. Completeness:

In a complete message, the audience has everything they need to be informed.

7. Courtesy:

Courteous communication is friendly, open and honest. There are no hidden insults or passive-aggressive tones. You keep your reader's viewpoint in mind, and you're empathetic to their needs.



Ques 1) Discuss the flow of communication in an organisation.

⑦

⇒ The flow of communication is the pattern of how messages are sent, received, and processed among individuals or groups of people.

Formal Flow/Channels of Communication

Information of various kinds flowing through formal channels, such as policy, reports is known as formal communication. The formal flow of communication can be categorized into four main types namely:

- Upward communication
- Downward communication
- Horizontal/Lateral communication
- Crosswise communication

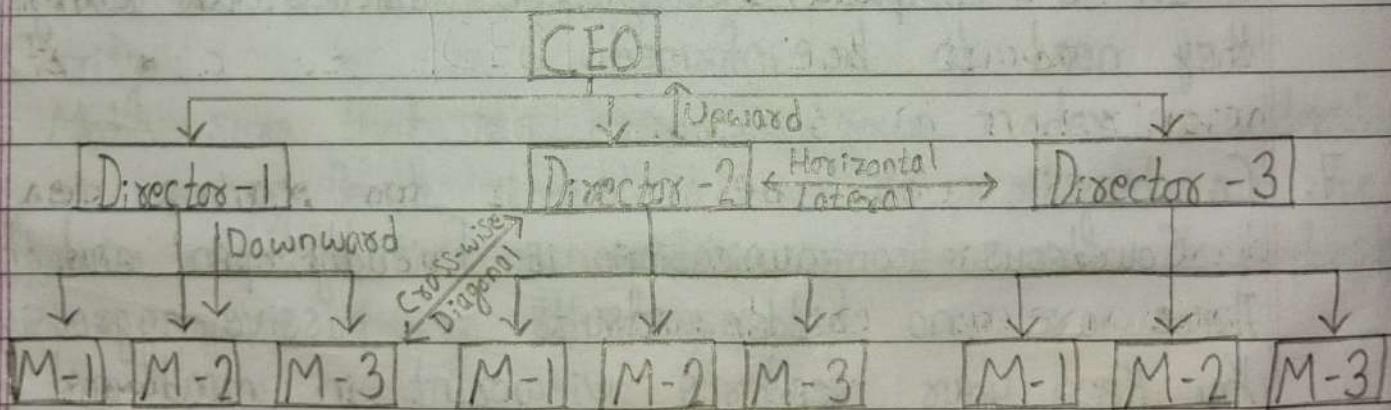


Fig.: Example of Formal Flow of Communication

1. Downward Communication:

- It flows from a manager down the chain of command.
- It is generally used to convey routine information, new policies or procedures to seek information or ask for an analysis etc.
- It increases awareness about the organization among subordinates and employees.
- It can take the forms of memos, notices, etc.

2. Upward Communication:

- It is also known as bottom-up communication.
- It moves from the sub-ordinate staff to the superiors. It is information moving from lower levels of the hierarchy to higher levels.
- It keeps managers aware of how employees feel about their jobs, colleagues and the organization in general.
- Managers also rely on it for making certain decisions or solving some problems which concern the organization.
- It gives an opportunity to the employees to vent their problems and grievances.
- Upward communication helps in identifying problems, grievances and other issues that need to be addressed by the management.

3. Latexal or Horizontal Communication:

- This form of communication takes place among peer groups or hierarchically equivalent employees.
- It is the most frequently used channel of communication.
- It saves time and promotes understanding and coordination among various departments.
- This type of communication is essential for employees to collaborate, share information and coordinate their activities with their colleagues.
- It helps in promoting teamwork, enhancing problem solving skills and improving overall productivity.

4. Diagonal or Crosswise Communication:

- It flows in all directions and cuts across functions and levels in communication.
- There is no specific line of command.
- It is also called radial or circular communication.
- It is quick and efficient.

Advantages of Formal Channels of Communication:

- Formal communication lifts up the image of organizations in a professional manner.
- It empowers employees at managerial positions with decision making and strategy development.
- Formal communication improves productivity at various levels in multi-fold ways.

- Formal communication ensures that the complete organization is kept intact as a single entity, irrespective of the distance between employees, managers, departments, branches, etc.

Disadvantages of Formal Channels of Communication:

- Formal communication involves hierarchy in communication.
- Following a hierarchy makes the communication task a time consuming one.
- Owing to its nature, Formal communication does not allow free flow of information.
- Formal communication involves certain set of activities which add cost along with the stringent practices.
- Due to the hierarchy involved in formal communication, human touch between the top level and the lower levels ceases to exist in many organizations.

Grapevine/Informal Channel of Communication

Grapevine is an informal channel of communication. Information that passes through informal means is not official but may be merely rumours or gossips. It follows no set rules and spreads like the vine of grapes in any direction, anywhere. It generally takes place among peer groups.

Features of Grapevine:

- It prevails more in the middle and lower rings of the organizations.

- Information through grapevines spread very fast and flows in every direction.
- This communication takes place between people in an organization due to their personal, social or professional needs.
- Informal communication usually spreads and discusses rumours that have no basis.
- At times, it may have some crucial information useful to management.
- It has no fixed standards or guidelines.
- It happens in a haphazard manner in organizations.
- Owing to the nature of the same, Informal communication is considered unofficial and casual.

Reasons:

- Low confidence of the employees.
- Low efficiency of the employees.
- Problems with formal channels.
- Preferential treatment of the superiors.
- Lack of direction.
- Psychological issues.

Advantages:

- Rapid
- Multi-directional
- Not expensive
- It serves as an outlet for worries and frustrations.
- It is a measure of public opinion.

- It promotes unity and solidarity.
- It carries more information than the formal communication system.
- At times it is more effective than the formal channels of communication.

Pitfalls:

- May reveal some degree of error.
- May be harmful in case it is baseless and imaginary.
- Unreliable and incomplete information.
- Nobody takes the responsibility for it.
- May cause damage to the organization because of its excessive swiftness.

Despite the pitfalls mentioned above, grapevines can be used in an effective manner.

Ques State the different barriers to communication and methods of overcoming them.

⇒ Hurdles or problems which affect the transmission of information from sender to the receiver in the communication process are called communication barriers.

Barriers occur at various levels. It is necessary to understand communication barriers, so that workable steps can be taken to remove them for effective communication.

Classification of Barriers:

1. Intrapersonal
2. Interpersonal
3. Semantic
4. Organizational
5. Physical

1. Intrapersonal Barriers:

The obstacles within the person are intrapersonal barriers. These barriers occur due to an individual's attitude, opinion, atmosphere, etc. We interpret the same information as per our thinking.

Causes: -

- Varied Perception: Individual in an organization perceive situations in different ways, e.g. The story of six blind men tells us how people have varied perceptions. The elephant is perceived by each blind man as a fan, a rope, a wall, a sword, a snake and a tree.
- Wrong Assumption: Sometimes the sender of the message does not have proper knowledge about the background of the receiver. His wrong assumptions act as a barrier. Example; When a doctor tells his patient that he has to take a medicine only as 'SOS', without knowing whether the patient understands the term or not, it is wrong assumption.
- Impervious Categories: These are, Misoneists (people having a closed mind) and Pansophists (people who think they know it all).

- Different Background: For proper communication it is necessary to know the background of the receiver of the message, e.g. A representative of a computer company will not make much sense to a group of doctors if he goes into the details about the hardware aspects of computers.

2. Interpersonal Barriers:

The obstacles that hinder effective communication between people are interpersonal barriers.

Causes:-

- Cultural Variation: This is one of the predominant factors in communication failure. Our success as professionals lies in knowing the business practices, social customs and manners of a particular country.
- Attitude: If an information does not agree with our attitude and opinion, we do not react favourably. This disturbs the process of communication.
- Limited Vocabulary: It can be a major barrier in communication. During our speech if we are at a loss of words, it leaves a poor impression.
- Misinterpretations of Words: Some words are capable of communicating a variety of meanings. This can create confusion in the mind of the receiver of the message. It may be possible that he does

not assign the same meaning to the word which the transmitter of the message had intended.

- Poor Listening Skills: A lot of misunderstanding can be avoided if we listen to the communicator with attention. Various factors that hinder listening can be emotional disturbance, indifference, aggressiveness and wandering attention.
- Emotional Outburst: If the communicator is perplexed, worried, excited, afraid and nervous, he will not be able to communicate his message properly.
- Noise: It is an unwanted signal which creates hindrance in the process of communication.

3. Semantic Barriers:

These are also called language barriers. These barriers distort the decoding of message. They occur between the sender and receiver due to the following reasons:-

- Use of ambiguous words or phrases.
- Differences in interpretation. For example, the word "cheap" has two meanings; Inferior in quality and less price. The communicator may get confused.
- Assumptions based on connotative meanings.
- Use of unfamiliar jargon by the sender of the message.
- Bad expressions.

- Use of symbols or words with different meanings.
- Faculty writing.

These obstacles distort the meaning of a message.

4. Organizational Barriers:

These are the barriers that prevent effective communication within the organization.

Causes:-

- Fear of Superiors: This is a major barrier to communication. Sub-ordinates are sometimes unable to put their point of view in a rigidly structured organization.
- Information Overload: Sometimes the receiver of the message is unable to handle the huge amount of data. In this case, the relevant (important) information gets mixed up with the irrelevant (unimportant) details and therefore goes ignored by him.
- Too Many Transfer Stations: If there are many transfer stations in a communication chain they may act as the barriers.
- Wrong Choice of Medium: Various media of communication available to us are- oral, written, visual, audio-visual, etc.

Example: Suppose an employee wants to express his regrets to his supervisor over his misconduct. In this case, the written explanation will not serve the purpose but face to face communication will be the best.

5. Physical Barriers:

Physical barriers to communicate are the factors that interfere with a conversation.

Causes:-

- Noise: Noise is a sound or malfunction that interrupts the sending and reception of messages during a conversation.
- Message Distortion: It occurs when the sender creates a message and omits an important detail.
- Technical Difficulties: It may be due to the malfunction of the channel transporting the message.
- Time: Time can impact the clarity of communication. Time barrier occurs when people work in different time zones.
- Physical Discomfort

Ques 9) What are the steps that can be taken to overcome the barriers to communication?

⇒ Steps to overcome the Barriers to communication:

- Plan and clarify ideas.
- Create a climate of trust and confidence.
- Time the message properly. For this, what, where, who, why, how are very important.
- Words should be reinforced by actions.
- Communicate efficiently.
- Use feedback.
- There should be clarity in the message.
- Use simple and meaningful language.
- Communication should be purposeful.
- Try to make one to one communication.
- Be sincere and honest regarding what you say.

Q) Discuss the process of listening and its types. What are the techniques of effective listening?

⇒ No communication is complete without listening. Several studies have indicated that business people spend almost 45% of their working time in listening. According to management guru Tom Peters "Listening is an essential management and leadership skill".

Difference between Listening and Hearing:- Listening is a process of receiving, interpreting and reacting

to a message received from the speaker. It requires focused attention, intention and conscious effort.

Hearing is an automatic, involuntary physiological process that happens automatically when sound reaches your ears.

Types of Listening:

- Active listening
- Inactive listening
- Casual listening
- Biased listening
- Critical listening
- Empathetic listening
- False listening
- Partial listening
- Reflective listening

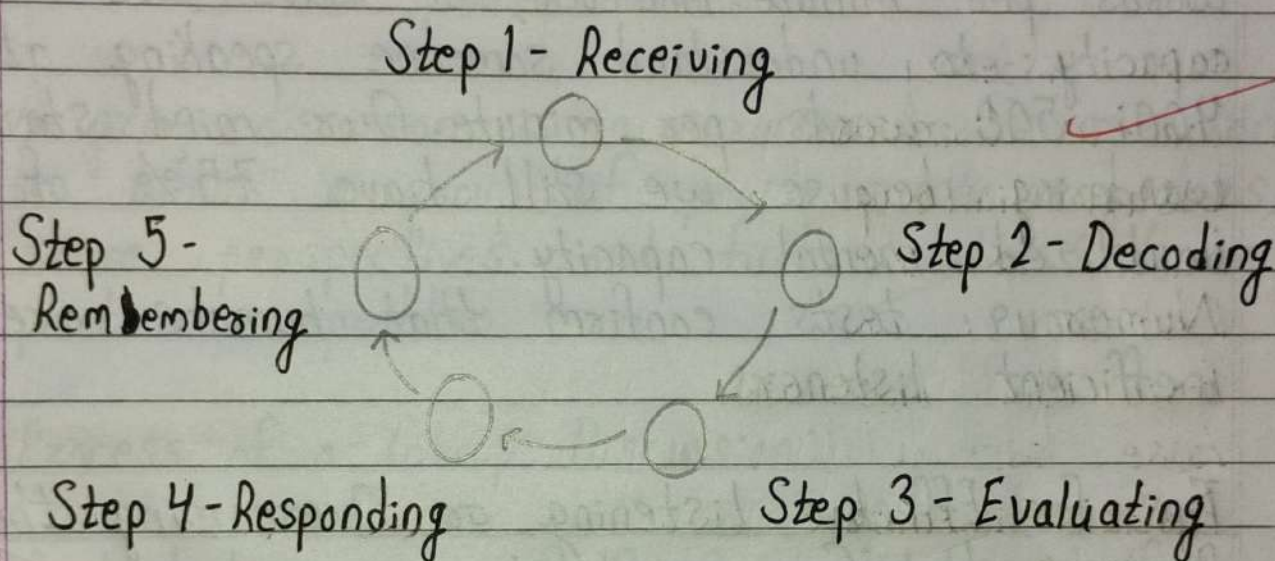
Listening Process:

1. Receiving - The listener perceives sound and identifies them as words.
2. Decoding / Understanding - The listener understands the words and gives meaning to the words.
3. Evaluating - The listener analyses the information.
4. Responding - The listener provides feedback to the speaker, either verbally or non-verbally. This can include

asking questions or summarizing the key points.

5. Remembering - The listener stores the message so that he can recall it later.

If anyone of the above mentioned steps breaks down, the listening process becomes less effective or even fails entirely.



Poor Listening Habits:

- Assuming that he or she knows everything that is important to know.
- Interrupting forcefully.
- Hearing not listening.
- Labelling the subject matter uninteresting.
- Doubting speaker's attention.
- Listening only for points of disagreement.
- Criticizing the delivery or the appearance of the speaker.
- Taking down no notes or ineffective notes.

- Becoming too stimulated.
- Listening only for facts.

Reasons for Poor Listening:

- Listening training is unavailable.
- Speed of thought is more than speed of speech. Most of us speak at the rate of about 125 words per minute. However, we have the mental capacity to understand someone speaking at 400 - 500 words per minute. Our mind starts wandering because we still have 75% of unutilized mental capacity.
- Numerous tests confirm that humans are inefficient listeners.

Tips for Effective Listening or Overcoming the Barriers to Communication:

- Be non-evaluative about the speaker's personal qualities, right or wrong, good or bad, suitable or unsuitable.
- Simply paraphrase and enquire from speaker to clarify a point.
Example; 1 - 'So you mean to say that'
2 - 'As I gather, you want to tell'
- Encourage the speaker to further extend the ideas.
Example; 'So you are suggesting that we might ...'
- Empathize with the speaker to experience what they feel.

- Use a warm, informal and friendly tone.
- Be careful with your body language.
- Use non-verbal techniques to indicate your attentiveness.

Ques. Group discussion is a very important round in the selection process. Discuss.

Ans. ⇒ A group discussion is a structured conversation in which a group of people exchange ideas, share perspectives and find solutions to a particular problem.

Process of a Group Discussion:

A leaderless group of 8-10 candidates is formed. A topic is given and the group is asked to analyse and discuss it among themselves within a given time limit i.e. 15-20 minutes. The group is given a few minutes to think about the topic before the discussion starts. A panelist or a group of panelists observe the proceedings and evaluates the members of the group.

Importance:

Group discussion is an important round in the selection process, be it for an MBA course, campus

recruitment or for any graduate/postgraduate degree. The selection committee conducts group discussion to gauge whether the candidate has certain personality traits and skills that it desires in its members.

The personality traits and skills which the selection committee looks for in the members of the group discussion:

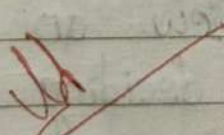
- Communication Skills
- Interpersonal Skills
- Leadership Skills
- Motivational Skills
- Team Building Skills
- Analytical Skills
- Reasoning Ability
- Novelty in Thinking
- Initiative
- Assertiveness
- Flexibility
- Creativity
- Ability to think and act independently.

Do's & Don'ts of a Group Discussion:

One needs to know that one's objective in the group is to be noticed by the panel and to contribute meaningfully in an attempt to help the group reach the right consensus. The first

thing is that the panel should notice you. The following tips can help the participants perform well in the GD.

- Avoid fancy and funny dressing.
- Take time to organize your thoughts before speaking.
- Starting the GD is a big plus. But take the initiative of starting it only when you have understood the topic clearly and have some knowledge.
- Maintain eye contact with the team members while speaking.
- Maintain positive attitude and positive body language.
- Listen carefully to the other group members. Allow them to speak even if you do not agree with their thoughts. Put your point once they stop.
- Speak politely, clearly and sensibly.
- If the group is digressing from the topic, take the initiative of bringing the discussion on the track.



Ques. When you are receiving requests for interviews, it is time to understand how to succeed in the job interview. Discuss.

Ans. $\Rightarrow$ Interview vary from situation ^{to situation} like - journalistic interview, academic interview, job oriented professional interview, opinion seeking data collection interview, police interview.

'An employment interview is a formal meeting during which both the interviewee and the prospective employer ask questions and exchange information.'

These meetings have a dual purpose:

1. The organization's main objective is to find the best person available for the job.
2. The candidate's main objective is to find the job best suited to his goals and capabilities.

Typical Sequence of Job Interviews:

Most employers interview an applicant two or three times before deciding to make a job offer. They are:

- a. Screening Stage: This is the first stage which is generally held on campus for the new

college hires. Interviews at this stage are frequently structured. The candidates are roughly asked the same questions. The best approach to an interview at this stage is to keep responses short and to the point.

- b. Selection Stage: During this stage the candidate will talk to several people in succession, such as a member of the human resource department, one or two potential colleagues and one or more managers including your potential supervisor. The candidate may face a panel interview during which several interviewers ask questions during a single session.

Tips for Success in an Interview:

- Conduct research on the employer, hiring manager, job opportunity. Information sources include the organization's website, other published material, search engines and your network of contacts.
- Another key to interview success is preparing responses to expected interview questions.
- Plan out a wardrobe that fits the organization and its culture.
- Arrive on time for the interview. Arriving a

bit early is also a chance to observe the dynamics of the workplace.

- Make good first impression. Be polite and offer warm greetings to the staff, members you meet. When greeting your interviewer stand, smile and make eye contact.
- Having a positive attitude and expressing enthusiasm for the job and employer are vital in the initial stages of the interview.
- Be authentic, upbeat, focused, confident, candid and prompt in response.
- Body language should be proper. Poor body language can be a distraction or a reason not to hire you;
 - Detrimental forms of body language are - slouching, looking off in the distance, playing with pen, fidgeting in chair, brushing back hair, scratching head, touching face repeatedly, chewing gum, mumbling.
 - Effective forms of body language are - smiling, eye contact, solid posture, active listening, nodding.

- Even if the hiring manager is thorough with his or her discussions about the job opening and what is expected, you must ask a few questions. Employers make a judgement about an applicant's interest in the job by whether or not the interviewee asks questions.
- The most qualified candidate is often the job seeker who does the best job in responding to interview questions and showcasing his ability. Sell yourself throughout the deal and close the deal.
- Courtesy and politeness are essential for success in an interview. Thank each person who interviews you. Write thank-you emails shortly after the interview.

Ques. Write a note on ice breaking.

Ans. ⇒ "An Ice-breaker is a communication technique that uses activities or games to help people feel comfortable and interact with each other."

Icebreakers are exercises that spark discussions so that the employees can learn more about each other. There are many icebreaker games that can encourage specific discussions or build new skills.

Types of Icebreakers:

- Team-building icebreakers.
- Group icebreakers
- Problem-solving or puzzle icebreakers
- Meeting or event icebreaker
- Introductory icebreaker

Depending on the icebreaker you choose and the number of participants, the activity usually lasts from five to fifteen minutes.

A Few Ways to Break the Ice:

Examples:

1. The Time Machine Question - Ask participants to answer the question such as; "If you were able to travel through time, in which time period would you go and why?"
2. Two Lies and a Truth - Ask a participant to share two truths and a lie and then tell others to guess the lie.

Importance of Icebreakers:

- They help in getting through the first difficulties in starting a conversation or discussion.

- The amount of time used for icebreaking is enough to get participants on a meeting.
- They are great for starting meetings, team building and make people receptive to learning.
- They improve listening techniques.
- They strengthen communication skills. Knowing how to convey information concisely and clearly is essential.
- Improve effective feedback skills. Icebreaker exercises teach employees how to get the information across in a positive way.
- Icebreakers are a quick, affordable way to learn more about the employees. Their strengths and weaknesses can be identified.
- Coworkers who know about their colleague's perspectives can form collaborative relationships.
- Many icebreakers can help employees develop good communication, critical thinking and problem-solving skills.

Ques. It is very important to have telephone etiquettes. Discuss.

Ans. ⇒ In the modern world we use various channels of communication such as automated answering machines, texting, emails, etc. However, some people still prefer telephone communication.

Meaning of Telephone Etiquettes:

Telephone etiquette implies the manners of using telephone communication.

Telephone Etiquettes include the following:

- Greeting
- The way we represent our business
- The way we present ourselves
- The tone of our voice
- The choice of words
- Listening skills
- The closure to the call.

Importance of Telephone Etiquettes:

- When it comes to business communication, phone call remains the best way to communicate professionally. Telephone etiquettes are extremely important. Nothing leaves a bad taste in the mouth of potential clients faster than bad phone manners.

- It gives personal touch and clarity.
- Telephone etiquettes make the other person feel respected. It builds the relationship in the professional world. It gives the other person a consistent and well-rounded experience.

Do's

Telephone communication becomes effective if we follow telephone etiquettes.

- The golden rule is to "make the kind of call you would like to receive".
- Demonstrate professionalism and create a good impression.
- Try answering the calls in the first three rings. This makes the caller valued.
- Start with a proper greeting.
- The call should start with the exchange of identification of the speakers.
- Sound warm.
- The tone should be positive and pitch should be pleasant.

- Body language radiates through our tone and style of talking so we should use professional body language when we are ~~own~~ on a phone call.
- Handle the situation tactfully. The choice of words should be soft yet stern and should not^{at} all offend the caller.
- Give undivided attention while talking over phone call. Be an active listener.
- Before placing call on hold for any reason, seek permission from the other person.
- Ensure all the questions are asked.
- Ensure all the solutions are given.

Don'ts

- Do not depend on mood swings while deciding to receive a professional call.
- Do not answer the phone too casually in a business setting.
- Do not leave people on hold for a long period of time.

- Do not talk with your mouth full.
 - Do not speak too loudly.
 - Do not lean too heavily on voicemail.
 - Don't be afraid to switch mediums e.g. using skype or text.
 - Do not use speaker while communicating.
 - Avoid talking over phone call in a crowded place.
 - Don't be ambiguous while talking.
 - Avoid round-about conversation.
 - Don't be rude or impolite.
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